

Matthias Florian Sahli

Postdoctoral Researcher

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SUMMARY

I am a postdoctoral researcher at the Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH) Business School, and was previously a researcher at the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) of the United Nations. I received my PhD in Economics from the University of Neuchâtel in 2023. My research focuses on the economics of intellectual property, innovation, digitization, sustainability and the creative industries. The goal of my work is to provide solid empirical evidence that supports current policy discussions. To do this, I invest considerable time and creativity in developing new datasets and conducting rigorous econometric analyses.

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2024 – present — **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Business School, Bern, Switzerland
Postdoctoral Researcher

EDUCATION

2025 – 2026 — **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Bern, Switzerland
Certificate in Higher Education Teaching (Hochschuldidaktik)

2019 – 2023 — **University of Neuchâtel** · Neuchâtel, Switzerland
PhD in Economics

2016 – 2019 — **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
MSc in Economics

2012 – 2016 — **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
BSc in Economics, minor in Political Sciences

2006 – 2011 — **Gymnasium Hofwil & Schule für Gestaltung Bern** · Münchenbuchsee, Switzerland
Matura; talent promotion class in fine arts

VISITING

2020 — **Copenhagen Business School (CBS)** · Copenhagen, Denmark
Visiting student

2020 — **University of Southern Denmark (SDU)** · Odense, Denmark
Visiting student

2017 — **École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL)** · Lausanne, Switzerland
Visiting student

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2019 – 2024 — **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), United Nations** · Department for Economics and Data Analytics, Geneva, Switzerland
Economist and researcher — PhD Research Fellow (2019–2023), then Postdoctoral Research Fellow (2023–2024)

2017 – 2019 — **Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property (IPI)** · Bern, Switzerland
Economist, Office of the Chief Economist — internship (2017–2018), then Junior Economist (2018–2019)

2013 – 2019 — **Velokurier Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
Bike messenger; member of the cooperative (passive member since)

2011 – 2012 **Stiftung RGZ** · Zurich, Switzerland
Community service, school for people with multiple disabilities

RESEARCH

19	75	4	5
publications & papers	citations	h-index	peer-reviewed venues

Source: Google Scholar, retrieved 2026-10-12.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Digital Reuse and Online Availability of Visual Artworks**
  M. Sahli, A. Cuntz & P. J. Heald · *Information Economics and Policy* · 2026 · 11 citations
- **Does the Digitalization of the Book Industry Reduce Its Environmental Impact?**
  M. Sahli, J. Bieser et al. · *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption* · 2026 · 1 citation
- **Is There a Premium for Legacy Artists? The Death Effect in Exhibition Shows and Auction Transactions**
  M. Sahli & A. Cuntz · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2025 · 4 citations
- **Sustainability in Context: An Evidence-based (Digital) Preservation Lifecycle Investigation**
  M. Pennock, M. Sahli & J. Chenoweth · *iPRES 2025, Wellington* · 2025 · 2 citations
- **Million Dollar Baby — A Primer on Film Finance Practices in the U.S. Movie Industry**
  A. Cuntz, A. Muscarnera, P. C. Oguguo & M. Sahli · *Industry & Innovation* · 2024 · 15 citations
- **Intermediary Liability and Trade in Follow-on Innovation**
  A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2023 · 20 citations

UNDER REVIEW

- **From Digitization to Diffusion: Evidence on the Economic Value of Open Cultural Heritage in the Generative AI** R&R AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
  M. Sahli, J. Bieser, J. Chenoweth, J. Suckling, J. Love, E. Lin, M. Martens, M. Pennock & U. Pottgiesser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Gender Gaps in Museum Exhibitions and Art Auctions: Evidence from Linked Exhibition and Auction Records** UNDER REVIEW AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
  L. J. Noll & M. Sahli · *ACEI Working Paper Series* · 2026 · 3 citations
- **Open by Design: Open Distribution as a Strategic Choice for Cultural Organizations** SUBMITTED TO PUBLIC MONEY & MANAGEMENT
  M. Sahli, E. Bertacchini & J. Bieser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Elvis' Ghost or Digital Replica? Publicity Rights and Integrated IP Strategy** UNDER REVIEW AT STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT JOURNAL
  A. Cuntz, B. Lutes & M. Sahli · *WIPO Economic Working Paper No. 89* · 2025 · 1 citation
- **Evaluating the Sustainability of National Libraries: A Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment** SUBMITTED TO NPJ HERITAGE SCIENCE
  M. Sahli et al. · *Working paper* · 2025

BOOK CHAPTERS, DISSERTATION & OTHER OUTPUT

- **Decarbonizing Supply Chains: Systematically Managing and Reducing Supply Chain Emissions**
  M Senn, M Sahli, J Bieser · *Berner Fachhochschule, Wirtschaft, 2026* · 2026
- **Elvis' ghost, Jordan's Airness, and the new economics of publicity rights**
  B Lutes, A Cuntz, M Sahli · *https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/elvis-ghost-jordans-airness-and-new-economics ..., 2025* · 2025
- **Empirical Essays on the Economics of Creative Industries** PHD DISSERTATION
  M. Sahli · *University of Neuchâtel* · 2023
- **VoxEU column: How the US film industry mitigates financial risk**
  A Cuntz, A Muscarnera, PC Oguguo, M Sahli · *https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/how-us-film-industry-mitigates-financial-risk, 2023* · 2023
- **Risky Trade? Appropriation Art, Copyright and Secondary Market Effects**
  A Cuntz, M Sahli · *https://culturaleconomics.org/risky-trade-appropriation-art-copyright-and ..., 2023* · 2023
- **The Covid-19 Impact on Artistic Income: Evidence from Germany** BOOK CHAPTER
  A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *CEPR Press & Covid Economics 82* · 2022 · 1 citation

- **Pommerehne Prize, President's Prize and Young Researchers Workshop Best Paper Award**
  F Etro, D Noonan · *Journal of Cultural Economics 45 (3), 513-514, 2021* · 2021
- **VoxEU column: Appropriation artists: Follow-on innovation versus intermediary liability and trade**
  A Cuntz, M Sahli · *https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/appropriation-artists-follow-innovation ..., 2021* · 2021

TEACHING

2026 –	**HES-SO — Haute École de Gestion Genève** · Economics of Innovation (guest lecturer)
2025 –	**Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH), Business School** · Entrepreneurial Law (Master), lecturer and module coordination ★ 5.5 / 6 · Digitalrecht (Bachelor), lecturer ★ 5.25 / 6 · Data Literacy (continuing education), lecturer · Lecture Series SDG1 (Bachelor), lecturer
2025	**EPFL, College of Management** · MGT-404 Management of Intellectual Property (Master) ★ 1.24 / 4 1 = best possible score
ongoing	**Supervision of Student Theses** · Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses, practice projects and applied R&D projects

SELECTED TALKS

11/2026	DINAcon — Conference for Digital Sustainability, Kongresszentrum Bern · Bern, Switzerland SCHEDULED
11/2026	Swiss National Library · Bern, Switzerland SCHEDULED
10/2026	DUN — Dachverband der Urheber- und Nachbarrechtsnutzer · Switzerland SCHEDULED
06/2026	European Academy of Management Annual Conference (EURAM 2026) · Kristiansand, Norway
06/2025	International Conference on Cultural Economics (ACEI) · Rotterdam, Netherlands (3 papers)
06/2025	IP-Network BFH — IP and Economics · Bern, Switzerland
04/2025	BFH sounding board meeting · Bern, Switzerland
06/2024	DRUID24 · Nice, France
03/2024	EPFL STIP Research Retreat · Crans-Montana, Switzerland
02/2024	Cultural Economics Online Seminars — symposium on causal inference in cultural economics · online (video recording on YouTube)
10/2023	Unlocking value from digital heritage collections — invited panellist (Wikimedia Italy) · Turin, Italy
07/2023	SERCI Annual Congress · Bournemouth, UK
03/2023	Digital Economy Workshop, University of Lausanne · Lausanne, Switzerland
11/2022	WIPO internal research seminar · Geneva, Switzerland
09/2022	SERCI Annual Congress, University of Colorado Law School · Boulder, USA
09/2022	European Policy for Intellectual Property Conference (EPIP), University of Cambridge · Cambridge, UK
09/2022	Tenth European Workshop on Applied Cultural Economics · Turin, Italy (participant)
07/2022	Urban Creativity Conference, University of Lisbon · Lisbon, Portugal
06/2022	Munich Summer Institute (MSI) · Munich, Germany
04/2022	Cultural Economics Online Seminar · online (video recording on YouTube)
04/2022	WIPO internal online seminar · online
09/2021	EPIP PhD Workshop · Madrid, Spain
07/2021	ACEI Young Researchers Workshop, 21st Conference on Cultural Economics · Lille, France
06/2021	IRENE PhD Meeting, University of Neuchâtel · Neuchâtel, Switzerland
03/2021	IP & Innovation PhD Virtual Seminar, University of Lausanne · online
12/2020	Research Workshop, Copenhagen Business School · Copenhagen, Denmark
11/2020	PhD Seminar Series, University of Southern Denmark · Odense, Denmark
09/2020	PhD Seminar Series, ETH Zurich (Law and Economics, Prof. S. Bechtold) · Zurich, Switzerland
06/2020	First Econ Online Seminar, WIPO · Geneva, Switzerland

10/2018 Reinventing the world — the power of Industry 4.0 · Belgrade, Serbia

OUTREACH, MEDIA COVERAGE & OTHER OUTPUT

PODCASTS

2023 Do Market Players React to Court Decisions Impacting Art? · Art Law Podcast (Spotify)

COLUMNS

09/2023 The effect of copyright on the digitisation and availability of visual artworks · VoxEU / CEPR

BLOG COVERAGE

10/2023 Life after Death: The Effects of an Artist's Death on Exhibitions and Auctions · EconomistTalkArt (ACEI)

REPORTS & NOTES

2021 COVID-19 impact on artistic income — WIPO Economic Research Working Paper No. 65 · WIPO

2020 WIPO Creative Economy Note 2020/21 · WIPO

PRESS

2026 Digitalisierung und Umwelt - Warum das Zusammenspiel von digitaler und physischer Infrastruktur entscheidend ist · Bulletin.ch; Bieser J., Sahli M.

ORGANIZED CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

06/2026 ICT4S 2026 International Conference, Bern University of Applied Sciences
Organizing Committee

11/2022 An Industry Practitioners Event on Intellectual Property Rights and U.S. Movie Finance, WIPO Geneva
Co-organizer

POLICY WORK

2018 Value of IP in the New Economy. WTO TRIPS submission (IP/C/W/648) · Co-author

2017 Intellectual Property & Innovation: Inclusive Innovation and MSME Trade. WTO TRIPS submission (IP/C/W/635) · Co-author

CITED IN POLICY PUBLICATIONS

2026 Crato, N., Di Novi, C. & Meroni, E. C., "Harnessing Administrative Data for Policy Evaluation in Labour, Education and Health Economics", in Data-Driven Learning in the EU, Springer
Edited volume, European Commission Joint Research Centre · cites A. Cuntz & M. Sahli (2022), The Covid-19 Impact on Artistic Income: Evidence from Germany

GRANTS & AWARDS

2026 Swisscom study — "From Data to Action: Do Digital GHG Management Tools Drive Real-World Emission Reductions?" (CHF 32,409)

2021 Best Paper Award, Young Researchers Workshop, 21st International Conference on Cultural Economics, Lille (USD 500)

2020 Travel grant for the study visit at Copenhagen Business School — Commission de Recherche FNS / Fonds des Donations, University of Neuchâtel

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Peer review Journal of Cultural Economics (3) · European Journal of Law and Economics (1) · Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (2) · Socio-Economic Review (1) · Applied Economics (1) · Economics of Governance (1) · Public Money & Management (1) · DRUID (multiple) · EURAM (multiple)

Memberships Society for Economic Research on Copyright Issues (2022–2024) · European Policy for Intellectual Property (2022–2024) · Association for Cultural Economics International (until 2027)

DOCTORAL COURSES

Workshop and lecture series in law and economics — ETH Zurich and the Universities of Lucerne, St. Gallen and Zurich (Prof. E. Ash, Prof. S. Bechtold, Prof. G. Hertig, Prof. S. Lüchinger, Prof. A. Stremitzer), Spring 2021

Obtaining data from the internet: data crawling for research in business and economics — University of Zurich (Prof. C. Peukert, Prof. J. Claussen), Spring 2021

RESEARCH INTERESTS & SKILLS

Interests	Intellectual property · economics of innovation · industrial organization · economic policy · applied econometrics · creative industries · art markets · sustainability · digitization
Languages	Swiss German (native) · German · English · French
Software	Stata · R · Python (basics) · LaTeX · web crawling

REFERENCES

Prof. Dr. Gaétan de Rassenfosse
EPFL

Prof. Dr. Jan Bieser
Bern University of Applied Sciences

Dr. Carsten Fink
Chief Economist, WIPO

Dr. Alexander Cuntz
Senior Economist, WIPO

E-mail addresses available on request.